

"A STRONG MAN INDEED, WHO IS SURE OF HIMSELF."



PRIME TIME: Radhakrishnan swears in Shastri

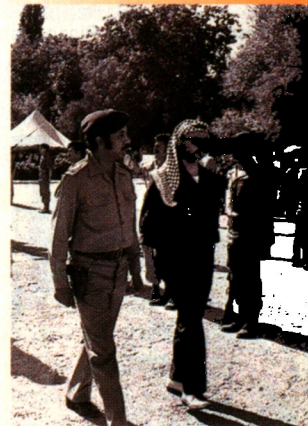
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Lal Bahadur Shastri

So said *The Guardian* about Lal Bahadur Shastri. He gave himself a slogan, *Jai Jawan, Jai Kisan*, which he took seriously when it came to budget allocations. Having inherited a nation which was psychologically and financially on an edge, he gave a sense of national unity to India. He also surprised everyone by building an innovation, the Prime Minister's Secretariat, which has evolved into the all-powerful PMO now.

- The G.I. Joe action figure debuted as a popular American toy.
- U.S. Surgeon General Luther Terry issued the first major government report saying smoking may be hazardous to one's health. A US report, "Smoking & Health", connected smoking to lung cancer.
- Fatah, the Palestinian guerrilla group founded by Yasser Arafat, launched its first armed attack against Israel. The annual celebration of this day came to be known as Fatah Day.

AP



GETTY IMAGES

Jayaprakash Narayan welcoming Sheikh Abdullah's release

"It is remarkable how the freedom fighters of yesterday begin so easily to imitate the language of the imperialists."

A Holy Call

Pope Paul VI visited India in 1964. Massive crowds gathered at the Oval where the 38th International Eucharistic Congress was held on December 4. A group of Hindus raised objections, though, thinking the Pope would try to convert people.



30 countries participated in the third International Film Festival aimed at providing a common platform to filmmakers and cine-goers.

4,850 people were killed in a cyclone that hit India and Ceylon.